By TOUCH DEN · November 11, 2026

Ethics, the Law, and Permission to Test



Video 1 · The One Rule, and Authorized Testing

Security Fundamentals · Section 9

In this video, you will learn:

- Why ethics matters more than any technique
- The one rule, made precise
- Scope, rules of engagement, and bug bounties

This lesson teaches the shape of the rules, not legal advice. Confirm your own country's current law.

Why ethics comes first

You can now describe how attacks work. That knowledge is what a ***defender*** *needs and what a* ***criminal*** *uses.*

The only difference is permission and intent.

- *Ethics isn't a soft add-on; it's the line between professional and criminal.*
- *A security career is built on* ***trust****: deep access, powerful tools.*
- *One serious breach, testing without permission, peeking at data, ends that trust, and often a career.*

The one rule, restated

> ***Only access or test a system when you own it, or have clear, specific, written permission from someone with the authority to grant it.***

- ***Clear & specific:*** *which systems, what actions, when.*
- ***Written:*** *verbal permission protects no one.*
- ***From someone with authority:*** *a friend who works there can't authorize it.*

Not permission: "I was curious" · "it was exposed" · "I only looked" · "I wanted to help." ***No fifth exception.***

Authorized testing: scope and RoE

When security work is authorized, it's written down before any testing:

- ***Scope:** exactly what may be tested, and what is **out of scope** and must not be touched.*
- ***Rules of engagement:** how, the time window, allowed techniques ("no DoS", "no social engineering"), emergency contacts, handling of real data.*
- ***Signed authorization** from someone with authority, before starting.*

A professional never starts without it. These protect everyone.

Bug bounties and responsible disclosure

Two legal ways to work on real systems:

- ***Bug bounty:*** *a published invitation, "test these systems, within these rules, for a reward." The scope* ***is*** *your written permission, stay strictly inside it.*
- ***Responsible disclosure:*** *found a real flaw with no bounty? Report it privately, give time to fix, don't exploit or publish.*

Boundary: *finding a bug is not permission to dig further.*

Recap: permission

- *Permission and intent are the only line between professional and criminal.*
- *The one rule: own it, or clear, specific, written permission, no exceptions.*
- *Authorized work uses scope + rules of engagement; bug bounties and responsible disclosure are the legal paths.*

Next video: *the law, your data duties, and what to do if you find a bug.*

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Video 2 · The Law, Your Data Duties, and Finding a Bug

Security Fundamentals · Section 9

In this video, you will learn:

- The shape of computer-crime law
- Your duties around personal data
- What to do if you find a vulnerability

The shape of computer-crime law

Almost every country outlaws unauthorized access. The shape is consistent:

- ***Unauthorized access** is an offense, **often regardless of harm**, just logging in without permission can be a crime.*
- ***Unauthorized modification** is treated more seriously.*
- ***Damage or financial gain** raises the penalties.*
- ***Making/supplying attack tools** for crime can be an offense.*

***Cambodia** has its own developing framework, **confirm the current law**. "I'm a student" is not a defense.*

Your duties around personal data

Personal data = information about identifiable people (names, phones, health, messages). Shared principles:

- ***Collect only what you need**, use it only for its purpose.*
- ***Protect it; limit who can see it** (least privilege).*
- ***Keep it only as long as needed**, then delete.*
- ***Report breaches** to authorities and affected people.*

*Your practical duty: access only what the task needs, never copy, share, or snoop. Misuse can be a **crime and a firing offense.***

If you find a vulnerability

1. ***Stop.*** *Don't probe further or exploit it.*
2. ***Check for a path:*** *a bug bounty, a security contact, a* `security.txt`*.*
3. ***Report privately*** *with enough detail to reproduce.*
4. ***Give reasonable time*** *to fix; keep records of good-faith contact.*
5. ***Don't demand payment****, that looks like extortion.*

Report it the way you'd want someone to report a flaw in your system.

Recap: law, data, disclosure

- *Unauthorized access is a crime in almost every country, often regardless of harm; confirm local law.*
- *Handle personal data with care: least access, no copying, no snooping.*
- *Found a bug? Stop, report privately, give time, never demand payment.*
- ***Defend, don't exploit; help, don't harm; act only with permission.***

Next lesson: *the frameworks and standards that organize security.*